DAILY MEDIA ENERGY MONITOR

20 Jun - 22 June 2026

BUSINESS RECORDER Founded by M.A. Zuberi	THE EXPRESS TRIBUNE WITH THE International New York Times	The Guardian	INTERNATIONAL THE NEWS PAKISTAN
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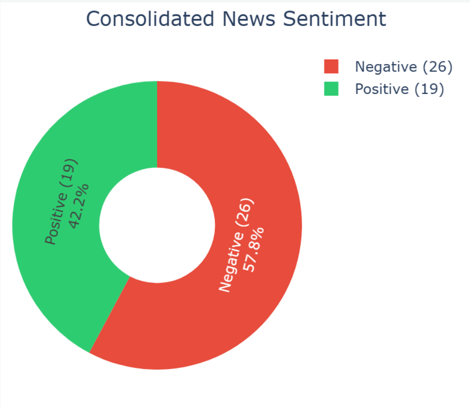

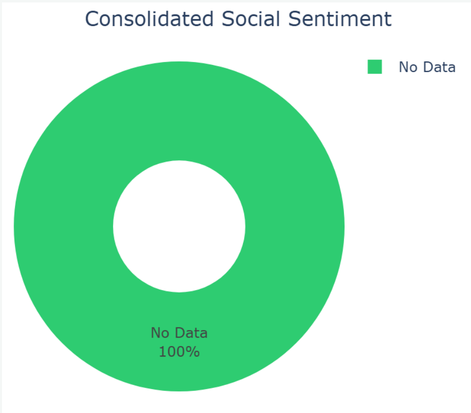

Executive Summaries

22 June 2026:

Pakistan’s institutional culture of self-preservation impedes innovation, while IMF austerity conditions exacerbate inequality in Global South economies. Khyber Pakhtunkhwa’s Rs121.74B supplementary budget and the National Assembly’s Rs4.4T energy grants signal renewed focus on nuclear and renewables, yet fiscal strain on the NFC Award reveals urgent need for horizontal resource redistribution—weighted by population—to curb unemployment and brain drain, potentially more achievable than vertical constitutional reforms.

21 June 2026:

Pakistan’s energy and climate policy is under intense scrutiny, with legal challenges to capacity charges and pricing transparency, alongside Supreme Court rulings on industrial taxation. PM Shehbaz’s inflation-fighting measures—petroleum cuts and export boosts—face pressure to lower electricity costs further. Criticism mounts over underutilized IMF climate projects and non-enforcement of levies like the Petroleum Development Levy, risking fiscal credibility. Amid this, the government accelerates its green transition toward 327,000 green jobs by 2030, though limited policy support and unequal access threaten inclusivity. Aligning energy costs with regional peers and ensuring climate-resilient, inclusive growth remain vital to economic stability and international financing.

20 June 2026:

Pakistan faces acute fiscal and energy challenges, with inflation at 15.28% and debt exceeding Rs81.93T, fueling pressure on public finances and utility access. While recent fuel price cuts and global oil easing offer temporary relief, structural issues—like weak infrastructure, climate vulnerability, and stalled EV policy—persist. Energy reforms, including DISCO privatization and airport outsourcing, aim to boost activity, yet enforcement of payment compliance and SME support remain critical. The freelance economy thrives amid digital growth, while capital shifts to banking, and climate risks intensify with El Niño. Diplomatic efforts to unlock energy cooperation and global climate pledges clash with delayed transitions and fossil fuel approvals, underscoring the urgency for sustainable, export-led, and resilient policy.

Key Energy Topics

Net Metering

Solarization

Privatisation

Can we electrify the world? Ambition moves from nerdish backwater to centre stage

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BMPP says debt servicing swallowing over half of tax revenue - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's fiscal strain intensifies as debt servicing consumes >50% of tax revenue, with government debt rising to Rs81.93T. Industry leaders warn of stifled investment due to high costs and interest rates, urging SBP to lower policy rates and redirect capital toward productive sectors. Renewables and energy efficiency remain underprioritized amid borrowing-led growth....

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BMPP concerned at Rs8tn interest payment - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's fiscal pressure intensifies as debt servicing consumes >50% of tax revenue, with rising interest rates stifling investment. Industrialists shift capital to banks, urging the SBP to lower rates and prioritize export-led growth over borrowing. Renewables and productivity gains are sidelined amid fiscal austerity....

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Building next chapter of Pakistan-China cooperation: Beyond friendship - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan and China celebrate 75 years of strategic partnership, with CPEC driving infrastructure and industrial growth. Future focus lies in renewables, tech transfer, education, and innovation to boost economic diversification and sustainable development, aiming for a 2050 vision rooted in human capital and green energy....

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IMF disagrees with 1% NEV sales tax

Pakistan's auto policy faces delays amid inter-ministerial disputes and IMF rejection of tax concessions for EVs. The government seeks to boost renewables via EV incentives, but clashes over duties, localisation, and tariff structures stall implementation. IMF insists on standard tax rates, while industry pushes for exemptions and phased duty reductions to meet 2030 targets....

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Skilling young entrepreneurs in a fast-evolving green economy

Pakistan is accelerating its green transition amid climate vulnerability, with renewables poised to create 327,000 jobs by 2030. Inclusive green skills programs and local entrepreneurship are key, yet limited policy support hinders growth. The government must prioritize equitable access, enabling infrastructure, and regional competition to ensure no group is left behind in Pakistan's climate-resilient economy....

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Privatisation board okays FESCO restructuring

Pakistan's Privatisation Commission approves restructuring of FESCO and other DISCOs for private investment, with KPMG-led consortium selected as financial adviser. Also, Islamabad International Airport's operations will be outsourced via ADB-backed concession model, aiming to boost efficiency and service delivery....

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Is IMF's cure worse than the disease?

IMF conditionality policies, tied to austerity and macroeconomic targets, have consistently hindered growth in Global South economies, worsening inequality and poverty. Critics argue IMF programs prioritize financial accounting over economic policy, undermining sovereignty. Renewables and supply-side reforms are urged as alternatives to IMF-driven debt and austerity....

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A viral doomsday scenario aims to shake Europe out of its AI complacency

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Traders hail Rs74 petrol price cut

Pakistan reduced petrol and diesel prices by Rs74 and Rs67 per litre, welcomed by businesses as boosting economic activity. Leaders urge further energy sector reforms, including lower electricity prices and surcharge removal, to enhance industrial competitiveness amid regional trade pressures....

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Tariff Hikes

The robots are not waiting - Opinion - Business Recorder

China leads global industrial automation, surpassing advanced economies in robot density and productivity, reshaping global supply chains. Pakistan's stagnant industrialization contrasts sharply with Vietnam's success, highlighting institutional failure. Western nations are now reshaping trade policy to counter China's dominance, signaling a new era of geopolitical competition in manufacturing....

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Fuel Price Adjustment

PM's massive fuel price cut set to cool inflation

Pakistan slashed petrol and diesel prices by Rs74.28/litre and Rs67.31/litre, leveraging falling global oil prices ($75/bbl) post-Iran-US peace deal. PM Shehbaz Sharif credited fiscal savings and regional stability, citing no shortages or queues. The move aims to curb inflation, with government savings of Rs129 billion supporting public relief....

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Islamabad's diplomatic moment - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's diplomatic mediation of U.S.-Iran agreement opens avenues for economic revival, energy cooperation (e.g., gas pipeline), and regional integration. While geopolitical dividends are significant, sustainable gains hinge on easing sanctions, revitalizing trade, and converting diplomacy into tangible investment and connectivity benefits across South Asia and beyond....

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Load Shedding

Our climate gauntlet and the world's empty promises

Pakistan faces escalating climate extremes—heatwaves and floods—despite contributing <1% of global emissions. Strained by 70% debt-to-GDP and IMF constraints, it lacks fiscal space for adaptation. While the government launches mitigation plans, structural inequity in global climate finance and debt frameworks leaves Pakistan vulnerable, demanding urgent, binding international support....

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'It's Russian roulette': alarm as Europe backs critical minerals mines in water-stressed regions

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Govt eyes 20pc rate of return to attract buyers for three Discos - Business Recorder

Pakistan plans to privatize three Discos with 14–20% returns, via regulatory reforms, self-generation permits, and tariff stability. Investors seek stronger NEPRA, competition in power trading, and 8–10 year tariffs. Bidding begins 2026; foreign and local investors targeted. Goal: reduce losses, boost efficiency, and complete 5 privatisations in FY2026-27....

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How Europe's EV makers shrank their product to challenge the bloated SUVs

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Tech experts urge focus on five-layer AI stack to boost IT sector in Pakistan - Technology - Business Recorder

Pakistan's IT sector surged past $4B in exports and $1B in freelancer earnings, with experts urging a strategic, five-layer AI stack upgrade—prioritizing energy, chips, models, and applications. Key to success: sovereign AI, USD-denominated incentives, and structural reforms to avoid labor arbitrage and talent drain. The sector's pivot from freelancing to high-value engineering and IP is critical for global competitiveness....

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Defensive by default - BR Research - Business Recorder

Pakistan's institutions have entrenched a culture of self-preservation amid chronic scarcity, stifling innovation and value creation. Despite survival, they avoid risk and discretion, mistaking institutional inertia for progress. True reform requires professionals who prioritize value over protection—breaking the cycle of defensiveness to unlock genuine performance....

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El Niño is back with a vengeance – and fears of 'Godzilla' strength may be the least of our worries

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Ending fossil fuel use

Global climate talks in Bonn highlight urgent need to cut fossil fuel use by 2035, with 2070 zero-emission target. Despite climate crises, governments approve new oil/gas projects, especially in vulnerable nations like Pakistan. Wealthier nations face criticism for delaying transition while funding gaps and tech transfer failures hinder global equity. Fossil fuels' dominance (70% of emissions) makes continued expansion incompatible with 1.5°C goa...

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NFC Award: a system under strain - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's NFC Award faces fiscal strain due to unsustainable vertical and horizontal resource distribution. Vertical imbalance, rooted in 18th Amendment assumptions, may require constitutional change. Horizontal formula, heavily weighted by population, exacerbates unemployment and brain drain. Reforming horizontal distribution—without constitutional amendment—may be more urgent and achievable than vertical revision....

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Nepra slams SEPCO CEO over prolonged windstorm outage - Business Recorder

NEPRA criticizes SEPCO for poor emergency response and negligence during a windstorm-caused blackout, demanding a detailed report within three days. The regulator highlights systemic failures, delayed restoration, and CEO's unprofessional conduct, warning of legal action. Incident underscores urgent need for infrastructure resilience and regulatory compliance....

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Freelancers hit $1b to 25% of IT exports

Pakistan's freelance economy surged, with IT exports hitting $4B and freelancers contributing $1.06B in forex—up 49.7% YoY. Driven by policy support, AI adoption, and digital infrastructure, freelancers now account for 25% of IT exports. Calls for transparency, better infrastructure, and AI skills training are key to sustaining growth....

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'Debt servicing swallows half of tax revenue'

Pakistan's fiscal pressure intensifies as debt servicing consumes >50% of tax revenue, with government debt rising to Rs81.93T. Experts urge debt reduction, lower interest rates, and export-led growth to curb reliance on borrowing, amid shifting capital from manufacturing to banking due to high costs and policy rigidity....

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Business leaders criticise federal budget, call for structural economic reforms - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's business leaders criticise Federal Budget 2026-27 for inadequate reforms, tax distortions, and lack of investment-friendly policies. They urge tax simplification, anti-smuggling measures, and greater private-sector engagement, warning of unsustainable trade imbalances and banking sector misalignment with economic growth. Renewables and digitalisation are not prioritised....

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Budget discrepancy claims based on 'misinterpretation' of figures, says Aurangzeb

Pakistan's budget emphasizes economic stability, with $14B in extra revenue, 4% growth target, and $300B in farmer loans. Energy reforms include telecom tax cuts, GST reductions, and targeted subsidies. Renewables and disaster preparedness urged; Balochistan and digital access highlighted. Inflation at 8.2%, exports rising....

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SPI inflation stays elevated at 15% YoY

Pakistan's inflation remains high (15.28% YoY), driven by food and utility costs, despite petrol/diesel price cuts and global oil easing. Lower-income groups bear the brunt. Currency slightly strengthened, gold prices fell, and global Fed signals fueled dollar strength. Renewables not mentioned....

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Misc

‘Godzilla’ El Nino: scientific warning or media hype?

El Niño is intensifying, with 80% probability of a moderate-to-strong event, potentially amplifying climate impacts. Global agencies warn of severe weather disruptions, food insecurity, and droughts/floods across Asia, Africa, and South America. Experts stress preparation over panic, noting El Niño may temporarily slow warming by releasing ocean heat....

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Power bills cost19 police personnel their quarters

Sindh authorities have cancelled housing allotments for 19 police officers due to unpaid electricity bills, enforcing salary deductions for defaulters. This marks a strict government crackdown on utility non-payment, targeting public sector employees and highlighting rising energy cost pressures....

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New AI museum brings rainforest sights, sounds, smells

Dataland in Los Angeles, opening June 20, 2026, showcases AI-generated art powered by renewable energy. Using visitor data, AI creates immersive, evolving experiences, blending art, emotion, and nature. The museum, co-founded by Refik Anadol, promotes ethical AI and features partnerships with scientific institutions....

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Right-of-way reform critical for digital economy

Pakistan’s telecom amendment aims to resolve infrastructure bottlenecks for 5G and digital growth, clarifying rights-of-way rules to prevent delays. While concerns over fines and property rights exist, the bill seeks to enable critical connectivity for AI, fintech, and exports. Success hinges on enforcing clear, fair access rules — not just spectrum auctions — to unlock Pakistan’s digital economy....

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K-P faces historic 28% budget collapse

Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa faces its worst budget shortfall (28%) in FY2025-26, driven by underfunded federal transfers and poor provincial revenue. Key energy and renewables funds, including windfall levies, were withheld. Continued federal underperformance and declining revenue highlight systemic financial strain, impacting energy infrastructure and renewable development....

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PM okays withdrawal of austerity measures

Pakistan's government, led by PM Shehbaz Sharif, reversed energy austerity measures, restoring full vehicle allowances and 60% fleet operation, while retaining business hour restrictions. Renewables and energy policy shifts signal a move toward normalcy, though commercial closures remain in place to manage demand....

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MNAs favour adopting Senate proposals

Pakistan's legislature urges tax cuts on telecom, essentials, and energy subsidies to combat inflation; calls for Balochistan development, disaster fund reform, and youth policy consistency. Renewables and innovation funding are highlighted, alongside criticism of fiscal inconsistency and symbolic Senate role....

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Budget 2026-27 in focus: Challenges, choices & change: KCFR hosts seminar on assessing govt's fiscal priorities, economic challenges - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Karachi's KCFR seminar critiques Federal Budget 2026–2027, highlighting inflation, tax reform needs, and debt pressures. Emphasis on education, health, and infrastructure amid IMF constraints. Participants stress inclusivity, SME support, and fiscal sustainability—warning that revenue measures must balance growth with economic stability....

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Concerns voiced over failure to develop projects for resources secured under IMF's RSF - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces criticism for failing to develop climate projects funded via IMF's RSF, risking future climate financing. Parliament urges strict enforcement of Petroleum Development Levy (PDL) and Climate Support Levy rules, targeting non-payers and demanding 100% revenue collection to ensure fiscal accountability and international credibility....

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FCCI President welcomes reduction in prices of POL products - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government reduced petroleum prices, easing inflation and boosting industrial exports. Industry leaders urge further cuts in electricity costs and surcharge rationalization to enhance competitiveness. The move signals economic stabilization efforts under PM Shehbaz, aiming to restore business confidence and align energy costs with regional peers....

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LHC approached against capacity charges in electricity bills - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Lahore High Court hears challenge against capacity charges in electricity bills, citing unconstitutionality. Petitioner demands parliamentary transparency on agreements. Case highlights public backlash over perceived unfair pricing, though no immediate policy changes announced....

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SC rules generators producing taxable supplies not 'stock in trade' - Business Recorder

Pakistani Supreme Court clarifies that imported generators for industrial energy use are not "stock in trade," reversing prior tax rulings. The court rules the 2000 amendment to SRO 578(I)/98 is curative and retrospective, allowing input tax adjustments. This decision impacts energy sector tax compliance and reinforces the distinction between industrial machinery and circulating capital....

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LHC approached against capacity charges in electricity bills - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Citizen challenges legality of capacity charges in Lahore, arguing they violate consumption principles. Petitioner seeks court annulment and federal government parliamentary disclosure. Highlights ongoing legal scrutiny of energy pricing policies and transparency demands in Pakistan's electricity sector....

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KP presents Rs121.74bn supplementary budget - Business Recorder

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's supplementary budget (Rs121.74B) boosts expenditures to Rs1.433B, prioritizing infrastructure, education, irrigation, energy, law & order, and tribal affairs. Development spending rises to Rs608B. Funds allocated for Peshawar Revitalization, armored vehicles, and emergency relief underscore focus on public welfare and accelerated development....

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125 demands for grants approved: NA rejects over 200 cut motions - Business Recorder

Pakistan's National Assembly approved over Rs4.4 trillion in energy-related grants, rejecting opposition cuts, while allocating significant funds to defense, nuclear, and renewables. Key energy allocations include Rs22.58B for Atomic Energy and Rs1.34B for nuclear regulation, signaling renewed focus on nuclear power and energy infrastructure....

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Lloyds Banking Group to hire 300 tech experts to work on AI

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Trump hails Iran deal but conflict continues to cast long shadow over global economy

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